

AI SDR — Functional Process Flow

End-to-end walkthrough of how a lead moves from first "hi" to a qualified row in your **Lead Database** sheet.

1. High-Level Flow

[User chats] → [Chat Channel] → [Make.com Webhook]

→ [Google Sheets: lookup by email] → [OpenAI: SYSTEM + USER + history]

→ [Parse JSON reply] → Router

└─ Path A: send assistant_reply back to user

└─ Path B (if all required fields present): Upsert row in "Lead Database"

2. Stage-by-Stage Functional Steps

STAGE 0 — Channel Entry

- User sends first message on the chosen channel (Web chat / Telegram / WhatsApp / Slack).
- Channel forwards { session_id, user_message, timestamp } to the Make.com **Custom Webhook**.

STAGE 1 — Contact Capture (Gate #1)

Bot must collect **all 4** before anything else:

1. First Name
2. Last Name
3. Email Address (validated format)
4. Mobile Number (validated 10+ digits)

Behavior:

- Ask for missing fields one or two at a time, politely.
- If user tries to talk about cars first → acknowledge, then redirect: *"Love to help with that — can I first get your name, email, and mobile so I can send you options?"*
- OpenAI returns missing_required: ["email_address", ...] until all four are captured.
- **No sheet write happens in this stage.**

STAGE 2 — Vehicle Discovery

Once contact is complete, bot probes:

- Car **Make** (Toyota, Ford, BMW...)
- Car **Model** (Camry, F-150, X5...)
- **Year** (or year range)
- **New or Used**
- **Purchase or Lease**

Bot references **KBB.com** pricing tiers in replies, e.g.:

"A 2023 Toyota Camry typically ranges from \$24,000–\$29,000 on KBB — is that in line with what you had in mind?"

Constructs a kbb_url like <https://www.kbb.com/toyota/camry/2023/>.

STAGE 3 — BANT Qualification

Bot asks naturally (not as a checklist):

- **Budget** → monthly payment or total price; anchored to KBB Fair Market Range.
- **Authority** → *"Will anyone else be part of the decision?"*
- **Need** → commute, family, off-road, upgrade, replacement.
- **Timeline** → this week / this month / 1–3 months / just researching.

STAGE 4 — Lead Stage Classification

OpenAI assigns one of:

Stage	Trigger
New	Contact captured, no vehicle info
Engaged	Vehicle preferences captured
Qualified	BANT complete + timeline $\leq$ 90 days
Hot	Ready to buy $\leq$ 30 days, budget confirmed
Nurture	Timeline $>$ 90 days or budget mismatch
Disqualified	No intent / invalid contact

STAGE 5 — Persistence (Upsert to "Lead Database")

Triggered on **every turn** where email_address is present:

1. **Search Rows** in Leads tab where email_address = {{lead.email_address}}.
2. If found → **Update Row** (overwrite all 17 columns, refresh updated_at).
3. If not found → **Add Row**.

This means the sheet always reflects the latest known state of the lead — early rows may have empty BANT fields that fill in as the chat progresses.

STAGE 6 — Reply to User

- Path A of the Router sends assistant_reply back through the same channel.
- Conversation continues until lead_stage = Qualified or Hot, then bot offers **next step**: book a test drive / connect with a human sales rep / send inventory link.

STAGE 7 — Handoff (Optional)

When lead_stage becomes Hot or Qualified:

- Make.com adds a second path: **Gmail/Slack notification** to the sales team with the row link.
 - Optionally create a **Google Calendar** event for the test drive.
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3. Data Validation Rules

Field	Rule	Action on fail
email_address	Regex <code>^[^@\s]+@[^\s]+\.[^\s]+\$</code>	Re-ask politely
mobile_number	≥10 digits after stripping non-numeric	Re-ask
car_year	1990 – (current year + 1)	Clarify
budget	Numeric or range; strip \$, ,	Ask for range if vague
new_or_used	Enum: New / Used / Either	Clarify
purchase_or_lease	Enum: Purchase / Lease / Either	Clarify

4. Conversation State Management

- **session_id** (from chat channel) is the short-term key during the chat.
 - **email_address** is the long-term key in the sheet (upsert).
 - **conversation_summary** is regenerated by OpenAI every turn — a rolling 3–5 sentence recap so a human rep can catch up in seconds.
 - Chat history for the OpenAI call can be stored in Make's **Data Store** keyed by session_id (last 20 turns), or reconstructed from the sheet's conversation_summary.
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5. Error & Edge Cases

Scenario	Handling
OpenAI returns invalid JSON	Retry once with response_format: json_object; on 2nd fail, send generic fallback reply and log error
Google Sheets quota hit	Make.com auto-retries; queue with 5s backoff
Duplicate email, different session	Update existing row, append to conversation_summary
User abandons mid-flow	Row stays with partial data + last lead_stage; nightly Make scenario can email "still interested?" if updated_at > 24h and stage ≠ Qualified
User provides fake email	Regex passes but no reply; flag lead_stage = Disqualified after 3 turns with no vehicle info
PII / compliance	Add TCPA consent line before storing mobile: <i>"OK to text you about your vehicle inquiry?"</i>

6. KPIs to Track (add a Metrics tab)

- Leads captured / day
- % reaching Stage 2 (Vehicle Discovery)
- % Qualified or Hot
- Avg turns to qualification
- Top requested make/model
- Conversion to booked test drive